

Different Types of Facilitation

1. Develop professional skills

Professional skills include things like time management, coaching others, public speaking, leadership, project management, and conflict resolution. These kinds of workshops have specific skills that participants want to learn and develop, which means the facilitator needs to help them learn and hone those skills. There will be elements of instruction as well as practice, and the goal will be for participants to arrive at a shared or similar level of understanding and skill. Compliance training, such as sexual harassment or diversity training, usually falls into this category and may also fit into the category of proprietary assessment, model, or method below.

List some examples of professional skills workshops you have participated in or led:

2. Develop artistic or creative skills

This type of workshop would focus on something like writing, composing music, dancing, or painting. Again, the facilitator will likely be using both instruction and practice, but there is much more freedom for individual expression. Each participant will likely have a very different and unique experience as they apply what they are learning to their personal project.

List some examples of artistic or creative skills workshops you have participated in or led:

3. Proprietary assessment, model, or method

In this type of workshop, the participants sign up to have a specific experience. The facilitator has expertise and is usually certified in that product. These workshops often have a predetermined experience designed to achieve the goals promised by the sponsoring organization, and the facilitator's role is to take that group of participants through the official and approved process. Examples would be individual and team reports by 5 Dynamics, or the Personal Purpose Profile and Team Purpose Profile by Imperative. Some compliance trainings fall into this category.

List some examples of assessments, models, or methods workshops you have participated in or led:

4. Strategic planning or visioning

This type of workshop is specific to an established group or organization. The group engages a facilitator to help them work collaboratively to move their specific goals forward. The facilitator is not so much offering instruction, but rather creating a process that will help the group achieve its stated goals. This may include making some decisions about the future of the organization, exploring new opportunities, working through some roadblocks, or doing some long-term visioning and planning.

List some examples of strategic planning or visioning workshops you have participated in or led:

5. Personal development

These workshops can cover a wide range of topics—from health and wellness to relationships, and from personal finance to spirituality. Personal development workshops usually have a thread of exploration and transformation, so facilitators are creating the environment for the participants to go deep into their own history, values, and beliefs to achieve some kind of shift.

List some examples of personal development workshops you have participated in or led:

6. Team building

An established group enrolls to experience a series of activities that enhance their relationships, trust, and communication. These often include physical challenges that the group must face and work through, such as a ropes course or an expedition like sailing a boat together. It can also include a simulated business challenge or scenario.

List some examples of team building workshops you have participated in or led:

7. Other

Can you think of other types of workshops that don't fit into the above categories? If so, list them here: